



**First Semester 2026-2027
Course Handout (Part II)**

Date: August 5, 2026

In addition to Part I (General Handout for all courses appended to the timetable), this portion gives further specific details regarding the course.

Course No.	: ECON F415 & BITS F468
Course Title	: New Venture Creation
Instructor-In-Charge (Pilani & All Campuses)	: Prof. Jyoti Tikoria + Dr. Paul Lopez
Instructor-In-Charge (Hyderabad Campus)	: Prof. Archana Srivastava
Instructor-In-Charge (Goa Campus)	: Prof. Himanshu Seth
Instructor-In-Charge (Dubai Campus)	: Prof. Vilas H Gaidhane
Instructor-in-Charge (Ph.D. Drive Program)	: Prof. Hitesh D Mathur
Instructor-in-Charge (Design School)	: Prof. Khushboo Jogani

1. Course Description:

The purpose of this course is to not only study entrepreneurship but also practice it. Student teams are expected to create a technology product-based or service/SaaS-based startup and complete the business model canvas, including all the building blocks of creating a venture.

In order to create a successful startup, student entrepreneurs will be required to comprehend the five phases of startup creation: (1) idea and problem validation; (2) solution validation and product market fit (PMF); (3) go to market (GTM) and scalability; (4) operations and institutionalization; (5) Startup teams will work on customer discovery, product development, market research, technology viability, fundraising, competitive analysis, team formation, marketing & sales strategy, and storytelling. The course features workshops/guest-lectures from entrepreneurs, investors and academicians with strong experience in creating and running Startups. Participating teams will be assigned an experienced, dedicated entrepreneur mentor who will guide them through the semester and can choose to mentor after the course is concluded. The top teams may be invited to compete for seed funding in early 2027 to pursue their business idea for incubation after the completion of the NVC course and thereby launch the business.

2. Scope & Objective of the Course:

NVC's mission is to empower student founders with the choice and tools to become entrepreneurs Hence, the course aims to provide students with an opportunity to launch/ prepare to launch startups post-NVC. NVC helps them to think and act entrepreneurially. The central mystery of entrepreneurship is how to transform an idea into an organizational entity where people can channel their energy and creativity to produce a reliable output that creates economic value. Some of the questions that will be addressed are: Which specific market segment of customers should you focus on? How do you plan for a new venture? How do you build an effective venture team? How do you establish your venture's identity and legitimacy? How do you win customers? How will your venture make money? How do you manage your venture's dependence on key external partners?

3. Text Book:

Steven G. Blank: The Four Steps to the Epiphany, Lulu.com, second ed. Available online:

http://web.stanford.edu/group/e145/cgi-bin/winter/drupal/upload/handouts/Four_Steps.pdf

4. Reference Books:

- Osterwalder & Pigneur: Business Model Canvas, Wiley 2010
- Eric Ries: The Lean Start up, Penguin 2011

5. Course Plan:

Date/Year 2026	Description
Aug 6	Orientation Session for Founders, Mentors and SMEs
Aug 7-12	1:1 Mentoring + Chamber Hours
Aug 13	Workshop #1 on "The Entrepreneurial Mindset"
Aug 14-19	1:1 Mentoring + Chamber Hours
Aug 20	Workshop #2: "Design Thinking"
Aug 21-26	1:1 Mentoring + Chamber Hours
Aug 27	Workshop #3: "BMC/LMC"
Aug 28 - Sept 2	1:1 Mentoring + Chamber Hours
Sept 1 (Tues)	Workshop #4: "Customer Discovery & Market Insights"
Aug 4-9	1:1 Mentoring + Chamber Hours
Sept 10	Workshop #5: "Building Your Team and HR Fundamentals"
Sept 11-16	1:1 Mentoring + Chamber Hours
Sept 17	Workshop #6: "FUNDING THE VENTURE"
Sept 18-23	1:1 Mentoring + Chamber Hours
Sept 24	Workshop #7: "FINANCE FUNDAMENTALS"
Sept 25-30	1:1 Mentoring + Chamber Hours
Oct 1	Workshop #8: "OPERATIONS MANAGEMENT"
Oct 2-7	1:1 Mentoring + Chamber Hours
Oct 8	Workshop #9: "OTHER PEOPLE'S TECHNOLOGY"
Oct 9-14	1:1 Mentoring + Chamber Hours
Oct 15	Workshop #10: "IMPACTFUL PITCHING"
Oct 16-21	1:1 Mentoring + Chamber Hours
Oct 22	Elevator Pitch
Oct 23-28	1:1 Mentoring + Chamber Hours
Oct 29	Pitching - Mock Round
Oct 30-11	1:1 Mentoring + Chamber Hours
Nov 12	Pitching - Semi-Finals A
Nov 13-18	1:1 Mentoring + Chamber Hours
Nov 19	Pitching Practice
Nov 20-23	1:1 Mentoring + Chamber Hours
Nov 24	Pitching Finals

6. Evaluation Components: (key documents/deliverables and pitches will be evaluated across campuses primarily by external entrepreneurs/investors)

- 10% Mentor-Mentee Engagement
- 10% Class Participation
- 30% Key Deliverables:
 - Customer Discovery
 - Market Validation – sizing, customer segmentation and solution development
 - Go-to-Market Plans & Execution – product development & MVP testing
- 50% Investor Documents and Pitch Presentations:
 - Investor Docs - financials, executive summary (plus pitch deck for context)
 - Pitching & Q&A by External Jury Members

BITS reserves the right, at its sole discretion, to change or alter the entrepreneurship program guidelines in keeping with the mission to enhance learning and foster entrepreneurship.

7. Attendance, Class Participation, and Online Discussion: Attendance in every session is mandatory. Student entrepreneurs are expected to come prepared for each class with the required assignment or presentation/pitch. Your regularity in attending class and showing up on time is essential. We seriously encourage you to sort out your startup related issues with the assigned mentors and workshop speakers. Class participation and online discussion are critical components of this class.

As entrepreneurial teams, you are expected to be highly curious and ask intelligent questions that will help your startup venture. You are expected to respond to class & speaker queries in each session to get a portion of your grade.

8. Managing Mentor – Mentee Relationship- INDIVIDUAL SUBMISSION

Each team will be assigned a dedicated mentor.

This is the most important aspect of this program. Effective mentoring relationship will have a profound impact on your ability to create/launch/scale your startup. It is your responsibility to ensure communication with your mentor.

9. Chamber Consultation Hours: Will be announced in the class for each campus. For questions, contact the Instructor-In-Charge noted on page 1 of this Handout.

10. Notices concerning this course will be posted on the cross-campus WhatsApp group/email.

11. Academic Honesty and Integrity Policy: Academic honesty and integrity are to be maintained by all the students throughout the semester and no type of academic dishonesty is acceptable.

**Instructor-In-Charge
ECON F 415 & BITS F 468**



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